5

DRAFTING AND PATTERN MAKING

5.1 INTRODUCTION

Drafting and making a paper pattern for a garment is an art. There are various stages in garment making such as taking measurements, observing the body for special adjustment needs, drafting the garment, cutting a paper pattern, etc. The major work is translating the drafting into a garment. It is important to draft the garment properly in order to get a well fitting garment. Let us now see what is meant by drafting, why it needs to be done and how it can be done.

5.2 Objective

After reading this lesson, you will be able to do the following:

- make a drafting and paper pattern correctly;
- explain the need and advantages of drafting and making a paper pattern;
- cut the pattern properly.

5.3 MEANING AND NEED

Meaning of drafting

The basic draft of the garment, which is made on cloth or paper according to body measurements taken, is known as 'drafting'.

A) Need for drafting

1. For a good fit

In order to get a good fit in the final garment, it is necessary to make a drafting. The drafting is made according to the body measurements and this to a large extent, determines the fitting of the garment.

2. To save time

Drafting saves time because any defects can be corrected at this stage itself and one does not waste time in ripping out and stitching the garment again to correct defects.

3. Prevents alteration

Since the drafting is made very carefully, there are less chances of the final garment needing any alteration.

b) Types of drafting

Drafting can be done in two ways.

1. Scale drawing

The drafting which is made on a reduced scale, in a note book, is called a scale drawing (drafting).

2. Drafting

The drafting of the garment is made on cloth, paper or milton cloth according to measurement taken. A good drafting ensures a well fitting garment and hence is very important.

Meaning of paper pattern

A paper pattern is made after the drafting. When the drafting made on brown paper or newspaper is cut along the lines of the drafting, it is called a paper pattern.

c) Need for paper pattern

Making a paper pattern before cutting the cloth has the following advantages:-

1. Saves time

If we have to make more than one garment of the same size, the same paper pattern can be used which saves time.

2. Fault removal

Any defect which may occur can be corrected at the time of making the paper pattern.

3. Designing

Various designs can be tried out on the pattern itself to find out which is the suitable one. This makes designing on the fabric easier.

4. Layout

It becomes easy to lay out the pattern on the cloth. In this way, we can easily estimate the amount of cloth needed and optimise the utilisation of the cloth by laying out all the pieces of the pattern correctly. Any wastage of cloth and errors while cutting is thus minimised.

5. Maintain records

The paper pattern developed for any particular person can be kept and the same could be used for stitching other garments for that person without having to take fresh measurements.

5.4 DRAFTING AND PAPER PATTERN MAKING

a) Drafting

The following points should be kept in mind while drafting:

1. Have all the tools needed ready before starting.
2. Ensure you have the correct measurements.
3. Use a large table or a board for drafting.
4. While drafting on a paper use the paper in the vertical direction.
5. Pin the paper on the drafting board using drafting pins.
6. Leave a margin of 1" on all sides while drafting on a paper.
7. First of all, draw the 'base line' along the longer side of the paper.
8. Draw the other base lines perpendicular to the base line. These lines are the 'top line' and the 'bottom line'. The bottom line is always to the left and the top line should always be to the right.

9. Mark all lengthwise measures like shoulder to chest, shoulder to waist, shoulder to hips, depth of neck, etc. along the lengthwise line.
10. On the basis of these marks, mark out the widthwise measures like width of neck, across shoulders, round chest, round waist, etc.
11. Make use of the 'guideline' to help in drafting.
12. Shape the armhole, neck line, etc. with the help of the french curve.
13. Make sure that all lines are straight and thin.
14. Use a colored pencil or sketch pen to draw a design.
15. When drafting on cloth, make sure it is always done on the wrong side of the cloth.
16. Avoid rubbing often on the drafting.
17. The drafting should be as neat as possible.

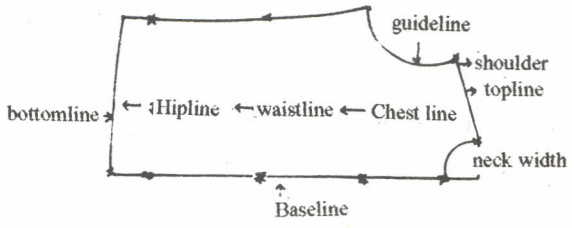


Fig. 5.1

(b) Making a paper pattern

When the drafting is cut carefully along the outer lines, it is known as 'pattern'. The pattern is placed on the cloth before cutting. It is important to keep the following points in mind.

1. Keep the note book with measurements nearby for ready reference.
2. The pattern should be of the actual size of the garment to be made.
3. The drafting should be made on the rough side of the paper.
4. The extra or useless lines on the drafting should be cancelled out with the help of chalk.
5. Always use a full-scale to make the drafting on paper.
6. While making a pattern keep allowances for seams, turning, in-lays, etc.
7. Set the design to be made on the pattern itself.

8. Mark the darts, gather, turning, etc. on the pattern.

9. Also mark the pockets, buttons and buttonholes and the pattern.

10. Check all curves on the pattern before cutting.

11. It is sensible to develop a pattern for only half of a portion which has two identical sides like half of front or half of back. etc.

12. Make the larger parts on the pattern first and then make the smaller parts.

13. While making a pattern note down the all the measurements on the largest part of the pattern.

(c) Cutting the pattern

1. Check the entire pattern carefully before cutting.

2. Cut the pattern carefully along the lines.

3. Make use of 'balances' and 'notches' on the pattern. This will facilitate the transfer of marks for pockets, darts, etc. on to the cloth.

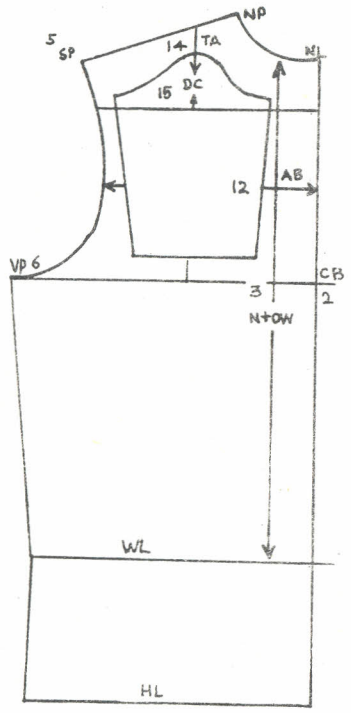
4. Make equal notches.

5. Cut all the parts of the pattern very carefully.

6. Keep all the parts of the pattern in a brown paper envelop and note down the description and other information on top of the envelop.

(d) Description of abbreviations used during drafting

C.F.	-	Centre Front
C.B.	-	Centre Back
N.W.	-	Neck to Waist
N.P.	-	Neck Point
S.P.	-	Shoulder Point
U.A.P.	-	Under Arm Point
B	-	Bust Measurement
Ch	-	Chest measurements
H	-	Hip measurement



N.L.	-	Neck line
Sh	-	Shoulder
A.B.(X.B.)	-	Across Back
A.C(X.C)	-	Across Chest
T.A.	-	Top Arm
D.C.	-	Depth of Crotch
S.G.	-	Straight Grains
W.G.	-	Widthwise Grains
B.I.	-	Bias Grains

INTEXT QUESTIONS 5.1

State whether the following are true or false :

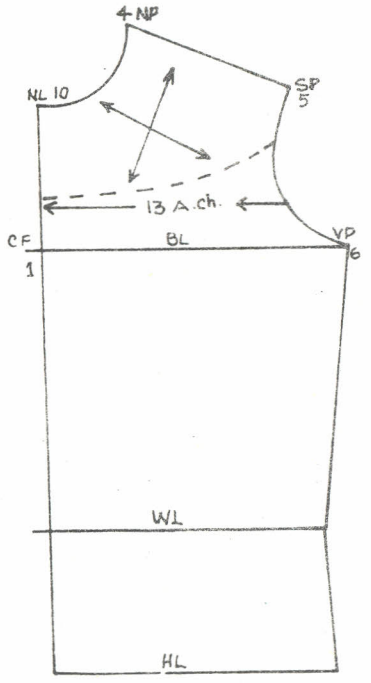
i) Drafting should be done on the smooth side of the brown paper.

ii) Cloth is not wasted when a lay out is done.

iii) Margins should be kept on a pattern.

iv) Drafting is the basis of the fitting of the garment.

v) The design should be set on the drafting itself.



5.5 TYPES OF PAPER PATTERN

There can be various types of paper patterns as explained below:

1. Ordinary Pattern

The pattern which is first cut is known as the ordinary pattern. This pattern can be cut according to standard measuremdents or according to specific given measurements.

2. Individual Pattern

The pattern cut according to the measurements of an individual is known as an individual pattern. This type of pattern can not be used for any other individual.

3. Readymade or Bought Pattern

These are available only in foreign countries. These are sold in various standard sizes. Women in foreign countries know how to sew but not how to cut. Therefore, it becomes convenient to buy the pattern of the correct size and use it at home.

4. Final Pattern

The pattern which is perfect in all respects and free from all defects is known as the final pattern. The final pattern is made after the customer has tried on the garment and the defects observed are corrected in the pattern.

5. Block Pattern

The pattern made according to given measurements with only the standard looseness is known as the block pattern. This kind of pattern has no other allowances such as for seams, turning, overlap, etc. Only the darts and the balance mark are put on the block pattern.

6. Graded Pattern

The pattern which has different sizes marked on it is known as a graded pattern. For example, chest sizes of 32", 34", 36" may be marked on one pattern itself. There is a difference of 2" between successive sizes. The pattern can be cut according to the size required.

7. Dress Pattern

The pattern made with the design, seam allowance, turning, inlay, overlap, etc., is known, as a dress pattern.

5.6 WHAT YOU HAVE LEARNT

In this lesson you have learnt about the meaning of drafting, their need, the method of making them and ahout the various types of patterns.

5.7 TERMINAL EXERCISE

1. Describe the need for a paper pattern.

ACTIVITY

Develop different types of paper patterns.

5.8 ANSWERS TO INTEXT QUESTIONS

i) False

ii) True

iii) False

iv) True

v) True